Submission to the Federal enquiry into all aspects of the conduct of the 2025 federal election

The 2025 Federal Election in Goldstein was marked by an orchestrated, highly organized, and well-resourced campaign of intimidation explicitly designed to suppress voter and volunteer participation.

I have been an active volunteer in [redacted]'s campaigns in both 2022 and 2025. The 2025 pre-polling in Goldstein left me severely traumatized.

Over the course of three months, I was relentlessly stalked, abused, assaulted, and intimidated by [redacted] supporters, *Repeal the Teals*, *Australians for Prosperity*, Rebel News journalists, and members of the National Workers Alliance.

At the North Brighton polling booth, I personally experienced the following:

- **Aggressive threats from [redacted] volunteers.** One volunteer told me they had called the police on me simply for standing in front of a sign, insisting I was acting illegally and demanding I move. The tone was hostile, designed to frighten me.
- **Daily harassment from Repeal the Teals.** Every day of pre polling they interrogated me about my identity and where I lived. Their constant aggression left me genuinely fearful they might follow me home. They were equally hostile to other volunteers and to voters.
- **Intimidation by Rebel News.** A Rebel News journalist repeatedly shoved a camera and microphone into my face, shouting "[redacted]'s an antisemite." Despite my repeated pleas for him to leave me alone, he continued to pursue and provoke me.
- **Verbal abuse from the National Workers Alliance.** One member stood in the voting queue, screaming abuse into my face and that of another [redacted] volunteer. He was physically imposing, extremely aggressive, and made me feel unsafe. I retreated into the polling booth to report the incident to the AEC, who told me they could do nothing. I was left shaken for days afterwards.
- **Witnessing abuse of a young volunteer.** I had to intervene when a voter spat on a young volunteer and called them a "[redacted] idiot." The young person was deeply distressed and had to withdraw from duty.
- **Coordinated disruption with sound equipment.** On the final day of pre-polling, two National Workers Alliance members brought massive speakers and blasted misinformation, shouting abuse about candidates—particularly [redacted]—for over an hour. Their harassment was deafening and could be heard 200 meters away. When I asked AEC staff to intervene, they said they could not. When I called Victoria Police, they told me they could only act if explicit threats were made. The result was an hour of unchecked, abusive noise directed at every voter present.

The overall environment at the pre-polling booth was **oppressively hostile** and at times resembled a mob scene.

- At peak, up to 80 volunteers crowded the booth, including numerous third-party activists from groups such as Advance Australia, Repeal the Teals, and Australians for Prosperity. Some wore both [redacted] Party shirts and *Repeal the Teals* shirts interchangeably, blurring accountability.

- The footpaths were choked with an extraordinary number of signs from both candidates and third-party groups. At times, every available stretch of pavement was plastered with signage.
- The walkways were lined shoulder-to-shoulder with campaigners, creating an intimidating gauntlet. *Repeal the Teals* operatives actively harangued voters in queues, pressuring them before they could even enter the booth.
- The [redacted] candidate himself repeatedly blocked the seven-metre boundary, aggressively forcing a handshake on every voter with the words: *"Hello, I am* [redacted]*."* Many voters described this behavior as overbearing and coercive.

The combined effect of these actions created a **toxic, intimidating, and unsafe environment** for both voters and volunteers.

The Repeal the Teals have publicly stated that "We had people walking up and down the lines [of voters], talking to people. They didn't just stand there handing out a pamphlet, they were really engaging with the public". This was in fact harassment of voters in the voter queues.

They have also stated that they are going to scale up and pursue this approach at future elections. "We are going to set up something, an organisation [but] what that looks like, and how it's going to be and what it's going to be called we don't know yet, but there will be something".

Here is a link to the article published in the Australian Jewish News which details these comments. [redacted]

This shows that third party organizations are going to increase their involvement in polling booths and disrupt the voting process.

I am making this submission asking that my name be suppressed from the public as I am concerned about retribution. As a known [redacted] supporter, I have been targeted for abuse within the community and online. I have been followed and photographed by the [redacted] party candidate prior to the election.

I am now stepping away from public involvement in the campaign out of fear for my personal safety.

I have seen actively engaged volunteers targeted relentlessly. Some examples are

- Volunteer's employers have been rung and told to sack an employee for their involvement in the campaign.
- Community organizations that have had [redacted] supporters in leadership positions have been told that they will not receive government funding if that person was in that position.
- Volunteers followed at public events and abused by [redacted] Party supporters.

Recommendations to Protect Electoral Integrity

1. Ban third-party organizations from operating at polling booths entirely.
2. Cap the number of campaign volunteers allowed per candidate at each booth.
3. Strictly limit the number and size of campaign signs permitted at each polling booth.
4. Prohibit campaigners from approaching or harassing voters while they are standing in queues.